

lution isn't everything and it would be an understatement to say that the quality left a lot to be desired. After all, it's not like we haven't seen better photos before. There were point and shoot digital cameras producing much better photos. And of course, the film cameras that produced great photos.

Other than being able to take photos that looked like they were captured by a potato, phone camera software back then was also a lot basic. The camera 'experience' back then basically involved starting the camera app, pointing and shooting. But then there was also a certain charm to it. Because of its absolutely basic nature, it encouraged a very casual approach to photography, something that a proper camera would not. This meant that even people who have never used a camera before or not much into photography as such, could take a photo without worrying too much about how they are shooting. It's this ability to quickly and casually take a photo is what has always been the most endearing aspect of mobile photography.

But what about after you took the photo? Well, there wasn't much you could do with it. You could either look at that low resolution image on an even lower resolution display of your phone (with individual pixels so big they could



Nokia 7610

be seen from the moon) or you could use the limited sharing options to send it to someone. The popular way back then was to use Bluetooth, which allowed more than one person to have a copy of that mediocre photo.

But this clearly did not stop people from using the cameras on their phones. As mentioned before, the speed and ease of use of taking photos with their phones meant more and more people were starting to take photos with their phones. Taking terrible photos, but taking them nonetheless. Eventually the smartphone companies noticed this trend and that's when all the fun started.

If you were from the era I just mentioned, then you will remember that back then, Nokia and Sony Ericsson were top dogs as far as mobile phone cameras were concerned. The two companies often traded blows and the battle continued for quite a few years, before Sony Ericsson finally con-